United Nations Human Rights Council

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Letter from the chair

Distinguished Delegates,

Welcome delegates to UNHRC. You've chosen this committee because you care enough about human rights to create discussions and the reinforcement of the rights. UNHRC is responsible for looking for solutions on issues like Child Labour and Women's rights violations.

It is with pleasure that I take on the role of Chair in this committee. In the six years I have been doing MUN, I've been everything from note-passer to co-chair, but this will be the first time being head of chairs of a committee, and it is an honour to be able to share this experience with my colleagues and the delegates that will be joining us for the two days of debate.

I trust this committee will be filled with respectful dialogue, critical thinking, negotiation skill and successful resolutions for both topics that are being discussed. I've been on both sides of the debate as a delegate and as chair, and I take it as a privilege to be able to see you delegates grow as I did once. I hope you will find it nurturing in your growth as a delegate. I'm looking forward to seeing your abilities in debate and problem-solving.

The international community's efforts to protect human rights and advance equality, compassion, and accountability are anchored by this committee. I urge you to cooperate in the spirit of multilateralism, speak with conviction, and listen with empathy.

Let this forum serve as a venue for the convergence of many viewpoints, the emergence of creative ideas, and the departure of each delegate with a significant contribution to the global progress of human rights. Your actions here are a reflection of the work of many diplomats who are committed to making sure that everyone has access to the most basic rights guaranteed by humanity.

I wish everyone of you a successful, courteous, and motivating committee on behalf of the dais. May compassion and reason lead your every conversation.

Sincerely,

Camila Briceno

1.0 Introduction to the committee

The UN's primary policy body on human rights was the UN Commission on Human Rights, which was established as an ECOSOC subsidiary and operated from 1946 to 2006. However, the commission thought it was not allowed to handle human rights complaints throughout the first 20 years of its existence.Therefore, it focused on establishing human rights standards and creating several historically significant international human rights resolutions and instruments during its first 20 years, working alongside other UN agencies like the ILO, UNESCO, the UN Commission on the Status of Women, and the Commission on Human Rights Crime Prevention and Criminal Justice. The most historically significant resolutions that were drafted in the council are the International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights and its two Optional Protocols, the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, and the International Covenant on Economic, Social, and Cultural Rights. As benchmarks for interpreting the UN Charter's human rights provisions, these three documents along with the Optional Protocols combine to form what is now known as the International Bill of Human Rights.

As benchmarks for interpreting the UN Charter's human rights provisions, these three documents together with the Optional Protocols make up what is now known as the International Bill of Human Rights. The Convention Against Torture and Other Cruel, Inhuman or Degrading Treatment or Punishment (1984), the Convention on the Rights of the Child (1989), the Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Racial Discrimination (1965), and the Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination Against Women (1979) were also crucial in this respect. These conventions each expanded on the provisions of the International Bill of Human Rights.

In today’s day and age, in order to address new human rights concerns, new human rights standards are being developed based on the Universal Declaration, and the corpus of international human rights legislation is still growing today. The rights of marginalized populations, including older adults, persons with disabilities, LGBTI individuals, and indigenous peoples, have been better protected in the twenty-first century thanks in part to

UN Human Rights. The Office has also highlighted the connection between climate change and human rights. To address changing human rights issues, many UN human rights bodies have been created over time. In carrying out their responsibilities, they depend on UN Human Rights personnel for both secretarial and substantive assistance. The ten main treaty bodies of independent experts that keep an eye on states' adherence to their treaty commitments are among these organizations, as are the Human Rights Council and its country-specific and thematic special procedures.

The discussion of peace, security, and prosperity on a global scale now revolves on human rights. The UN is now far better equipped to stop and address human rights abuses thanks to the inclusion of UN human rights personnel in peacekeeping missions. Additionally, there is universal agreement that grave human rights abuses must not go unpunished. The Rome Statute, which established the International Criminal Court in 1998, has made it possible to prosecute those who commit crimes against humanity and war crimes.

The idea that businesses have human rights obligations is increasingly becoming more widely accepted. For the first time, a global standard for preventing and addressing the risk of negative effects on human rights associated with business activity was established in 2011 when the UN Human Rights Council approved the Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights for the implementation of the UN "Protect, Respect and Remedy" Framework.

2.0 Rules

2.1 General Rules

1. Scope: The Committee Chair will be the final authority on what procedure to follow if a situation arises that has not been addressed by the Rules of Procedure. At the discretion of the Chair or Secretariat, these rules can be modified to better facilitate healthy debate,and any adjustment of the rules will be declared clearly to the entirety of the committee and will take precedence over any rules written in this document.

2. Language: English will be the official language used in MUN at CIC, in all documents and debates the English must be used.

3. General Power of the Committee Staff: The Chair has total control of the procedure of the meeting and any motion, the Chair is responsible to direct the flow of debate, grant the right to speak, ask questions, announce decisions, rule on points of order, and enforce adherence to these rules.

4. Quorum: It's the minimum quantity of delegates that are needed to start the conference.

5. Courtesy and Delegate Conduct: Every Delegate must be respectful and courteous with Conference members. If someone is being unrespectful, the Chairs must be contacted to take the appropriate action. CICMUN will have zero tolerance for slandering, disparaging, or any other respectful act.

6. Absence: If a delegate doesn't appear during the Conference, it won't be receiving the certifications and awards. Just in case he or she sends a note to the chair justifying the absence.

3.0 Objectives

1. To reaffirm the commitment of all states to uphold the human rights of all people in Afghanistan, with particular attention to women, girls, and minorities.

2. To urge the de facto authorities in Afghanistan to restore and guarantee fundamental freedoms, including access to education, work, movement, and participation in public life for women and girls.

3. To strengthen UN and international monitoring, reporting, and accountability mechanisms on human rights violations in Afghanistan, including gender persecution and possible crimes under international law.

4. To encourage member states and donors to provide predictable, needs-based humanitarian assistance to Afghanistan, ensuring that aid is not politicised and reaches women and other vulnerable groups.

5. To promote inclusive dialogue between the international community, Afghan civil society (especially women human rights defenders), and the de facto authorities, with the aim of securing concrete human rights benchmarks and timelines.

6. To reaffirm state obligations under core international instruments such as ILO Conventions on child labour and the Convention on the Rights of the Child, and to urge universal ratification and effective implementation.

7. To support the adoption and enforcement of national laws that clearly prohibit the worst forms of child labour, including trafficking, forced labour, armed recruitment, and sexual exploitation of minors, in all member states.

8. To promote access to free, quality primary and secondary education for all children, recognising education as a key strategy for preventing child labour and breaking cycles of poverty and exploitation.

9. To encourage the creation or strengthening of child protection systems, including social services, complaints mechanisms, and safe shelters—to identify, rescue, and reintegrate children involved in child labour or other abuses.

10. To call for enhanced international cooperation, data collection, and technical assistance, including partnerships with UN agencies, NGOs, and local communities to monitor progress, share best practices, and address root causes of child labour such as poverty, conflict, and discrimination
11. To examine existing international legal frameworks and national legislations affecting the rights and safety of minors, identifying gaps and challenges in protection and access to justice.

12. To foster international cooperation aimed at combating exploitation and trafficking of minors
13. To promote the establishment of mechanisms for training, protective measures, and emergency support for children working in factories or any type of job that is classifies as child labour
14. To strengthen international collaboration and information sharing among member states and organizations to enhance the protection of minors and eradication of child labour

4.0 Matrix

Country Matrix	
Austria	North Korea
Burundi	Pakistan
China	Qatar
Democratic Republic of the Congo	Russia
France	Sudan
Germany	Turkey
Iran	Uganda
Italy	United Kingdom
Niger	United States

5.0 Topic One: The current situation of Afghanistan regarding women's rights violations

5.1 History of the topic

The violation of women's rights in Afghanistan is the result of a complex historical and political trajectory shaped by conflict, ideological governance, and changing regimes. While women's rights have fluctuated throughout Afghanistan's modern history, the most severe restrictions have occurred under the rule of the Taliban. Since their return to power in 2021, Afghanistan has witnessed what many international organizations describe as a system of "gender apartheid" in which women and girls are systematically excluded from education, employment and public life. Understanding the current situation requires examining the historical background of women's rights in Afghanistan, the legal framework introduced by the Taliban, and the responses of the international community through laws, conventions and the United Nations resolutions.

Women's rights in Afghanistan have historically fluctuated depending on the political regime in power. During the early twentieth century, King Amanullah Khan introduced reforms aimed at modernizing Afghan society. These reforms included promoting women's education and discouraging forced marriages. However, these efforts were met with resistance from conservative factions, limiting their long-term impact.

Major progress occurred after the fall of the first Taliban regime in 2001. The 2004 Afghan Constitution guaranteed equal rights for men and women and allowed women to participate in politics, education and the workforce. During this period, Afghan women gained representation in parliament, attended universities, and entered professions such as journalism, law, and medicine. Despite these improvements, women still faced challenges including domestic violence, forced marriage, and limited legal enforcements of rights.

An important legal reform during this period was the 2009 Elimination of Violence Against Women (EVAW) Law, which criminalized practices like forced marriage, child marriage and domestic violence. However, the law turned inconsistent quickly as enforcement across the country was weak and the opposition from conservative groups was strong.

During the first Taliban Regime (1996-2001) the situation for Afghan women was significantly deteriorating when the Taliban first took power in 1996. Under their strict interpretation of Islamic Law (Sharia), thus women were largely excluded from public life. The Taliban imposed several restrictive policies, such as: Women being banned from working

outside the home, girls were prohibited from attending school, women were required to wear burqas in public, women were forbidden from leaving their homes without a male guardian (mahram). Their policies effectively erased women from public and political life and severely limited their access to education and healthcare.
Following the U.S - led invasion of Afghanistan in 2001 and the collapse of the Taliban rule, women regained certain rights. International organizations and the Afghan government implemented programs aimed at improving women's education, employment, and political participation. During this period girls were allowed to return to school, women were allowed to enter government and public office, and women gained access to professional careers. But, this progress remained fragile with the old norms still being deeply rooted in the culture and the weak legal enforcement continued to limit women's rights.

5.2 Current situation

Women's rights in Afghanistan is extremely restrictive under Taliban rule, with widespread limitations on education, freedom, and participation in society. Since returning to power in 2021, the Taliban have banned girls from attending school beyond primary level and employment through a series of restrictions. Women face strict limitations regarding movement across the country, women are legally required to travel with a Mahram (male guardian.). Rigid dress codes are also forced onto women as the Taliban believe a woman's body will tempt other men into sin. The many restrictions have effectively removed women from public participation and most areas of society.

The policies have serious consequences for Afghan women, their health, safety and economic independence have suffered greatly because of said laws and policies. Restrictions on employment have stopped many women from working in government, NGOs (nonprofit organizations), and even the United Nations.This has contributed highly to the widespread poverty within women-led households. Access to healthcare has been severely limited, as women are required to be chaperoned by a male guardian and will be denied treatment if they aren't accompanied. New legal measures have worsened the condition for women, recent penal codes that allow husbands to physically punish their wives and children, as long as it doesn't create any broken bones or open wounds.

The situation has been described by the UN and other humanitarian organizations as a society of institutionalized gender inequality and discrimination. Women are excluded from practically every human right by the Tabalian, these women live in a society where they are treated worse than an animal. Despite the constant and strong international condemnation, including the UN's Security Council Resolution 2681 that calls for the restoration of women's rights, the Taliban have maintained these policies through murder and oppression, leaving millions of Afghan women and girls facing non-stop violation of their most basic and fundamental rights.

5.3 Relevant treaties and resolution

5.3.1 Treaties.

- Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination Against Women (CEDAW) (1979)
    - The primary global treaty protecting women's rights.
    - Requires states to eliminate discrimination in education, employment, healthcare, and public life.
    - Afghanistan ratified it in 2003, meaning it is legally bound by its provisions.

- International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights (ICCPR) (1966)
    - Protects rights such as freedom of movement, expression, and equality before the law.
    - Taliban restrictions on women's movement and speech violate these protections
- International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (ICESCR) (1966)
    - Guarantees rights including education, work, and health.
    - Bans on girls' education and women's employment conflict with this treaty.
- Convention on the Rights of the Child (CRC) (1989)
    - Protects children's rights, including access to education regardless of gender.
    - The ban on girls' secondary education violates this convention.
- Convention Against Torture (CAT) (1984)
    - Prohibits cruel, inhuman, or degrading treatment.
    - Reports of abuse and punishment of women under Taliban rule raise concerns under this treaty.

5.3.2 Resolutions.

- UN Security Council Resolution 1325 (2000)
- Focuses on Women, Peace, and Security.
    - Calls for:
        - Women's participation in peace processes
        - Protection from gender-based violence
    - Taliban exclusion of women contradicts this resolution.
- UN Security Council Resolution 2681 (2023)
    - Directly addresses Afghanistan.
    - Condemns the Taliban's ban on women working for the UN.
    - Calls for restoring women's rights to education, employment, and public life.
- UN General Assembly Resolutions on Afghanistan (ongoing)
    - Regularly condemn human rights violations.
    - Urge the Taliban to respect international law and women's rights.

5.3.3 International Guidelines.

- Women, Peace, and Security (WPS) Agenda
    - A global framework based on Resolution 1325 and related resolutions.

    - Promotes:
        - Gender equality in conflict settings
        - Women's political participation
        - Protection from violence
    - Used to evaluate Afghanistan's treatment of women
- CEDAW Committee & Monitoring Mechanisms
    - Oversee implementation of CEDAW.
    - Review country reports and investigate violations.
    - Provide recommendations and hold states accountable.
- UN Human Rights Council Mechanisms
    - Includes:
        - Special Rapporteur on Afghanistan
        - Fact-finding and monitoring missions
    - Document abuses and apply international pressure on the Taliban.

5.5 Guiding Questions.

1. How can the international community ensure access to education for Afghan girls, despite Taliban restrictions?
2. What mechanisms can be implemented to protect Afghan women's right to work, especially in NGOs, healthcare, and humanitarian sectors?
3. How should the UN respond to ongoing violations of international treaties such as CEDAW by the Taliban authorities?
4. What forms of diplomatic pressure or incentives can be used to encourage the Taliban to reverse restrictive policies on women?
5. How can humanitarian aid be delivered without reinforcing gender discrimination, ensuring women both receive and help distribute aid?
6. Should there be international accountability measures (e.g., sanctions, investigations) for gender-based rights violations, and how would these be enforced?
7. How can monitoring and reporting of women's rights abuses be improved within Afghanistan?
8. What strategies can support Afghan women and girls at the community level, including access to underground or alternative education systems?
9. How can healthcare access for women be ensured, particularly under restrictions on movement and male guardianship requirements?
10. What long-term strategies can promote gender equality and women's participation in governance in Afghanistan?

5.6 Research starters (Useful websites to start your research)

- Shadow Brief: The Human Rights Situation of Women and Girls in Afghanistan | Amnesty International USA
- "We Have the Promises of the World": Women's Rights in Afghanistan | HRW
- UN Women Asia and the Pacific | UN Women – Asia-Pacific
- UN rights body orders probe into human rights in Afghanistan, with a focus on women and girls
- https://www.reuters.com/world/asia-pacific/un-rights--says-taliban-decree-expands-execuchieftions-deepens-repression-2026-02-26/?utm_
- 'A few beatings won't kill you': judge rejects divorce request of woman abused by husband in Afghanistan
- UNICEF Afghanistan

5.7 Block Positions

Country	Block Position
Austria	Austria strongly opposes the Taliban. It supports international pressure and humanitarian aid.
Burundi	Neutral. Limited direct involvement in Afghan affairs.
China	China has a neutral stance, as they engage with the Taliban for maintaining regional stability. But China hasn't formally recognized the Taliban.
Democratic Republic of the Congo	Neutral but sides with the UN policies.
France	Opposed to the Taliban, condemned its human rights violations.
Germany	Opposes the Taliban and doesn't recognize its government. Does keep diplomatic contact for security purposes.

Iran	Maintains relationships with the Taliban but doesn't formally recognize it.
Italy	Opposes the Taliban.
Niger	Neutral stance.
North Korea	Its position is neutral but shaped by its general isolation from international diplomacy.
Pakistan	Pakistan and the Taliban continue to have a complicated relationship. Despite not legally recognizing the government, it currently strikes a balance between collaboration and worries about border security and militancy.
Qatar	Qatar plays the diplomatic role as a mediator between the Taliban and the international community. While it does not officially recognize the Taliban, it maintains strong engagement and hosts negotiations.
Russia	In favor of the Taliban, it has formally recognized their government.
Sudan	Neutral, follows the UN's policy
Turkey	Engages with the Taliban, doesn't formally recognize it.
Uganda	Neutral, follows the UN's policy.
United Kingdom	Strongly opposes and condemns it.
United States	Doesn't recognize the Taliban, condemns its actions.

6.0 Topic Two: Child Labour

6.1 Introduction to the topic

Child labor remains a pervasive global issue, affecting over 160 million children worldwide who are deprived of education and exposed to hazardous conditions (International Labour Organization, 2020). This research paper explores the causes, consequences, and protective measures for minors, emphasizing legal frameworks like the UN Convention on the Rights of the Child and enforcement challenges in vulnerable regions. Despite progress, factors such as poverty, conflict, and weak regulations perpetuate exploitation, leading to long-term societal costs including illiteracy and health crises. By analyzing case studies from Asia, Africa, and Latin America, this study advocates for integrated strategies—stronger policies, corporate accountability, and community education—to eradicate child labor and ensure minor protection.

6.2 History of the topic

The elimination of child labour and the protection of minors is a long and pressing issue that we have been combating. The first laws to regulate child labour emerged in response to the brutal working conditions of the Industrial Revolution in Europe. One of the first steps to prevent child labor was the Health and Morals of Apprentices Act in Great Britain in 1802. And then the Uk Factory Act of 1833 which effectively banned work for children under nine, limited hours for older children, and, crucially, established a system of factory inspectors. The founding of the International Labour Organization (ILO) in 1919 marked a pivotal point. The ILO's very first convention, the Minimum Age Convention, 1919, set the minimum age for industrial work at 14 years. Throughout the 1920s and 1930s, the focus was on creating a standard for specific industries and addressing forced labour, laying the groundwork for a more universal approach. In the years following World War II, this world wide event marked the further spread of child protection laws like the ILO Minimum Age Convention, 1973 which remains a fundamental standard today. It requires ratifying states to pursue a national policy to abolish child labour and to progressively raise the minimum age for employment, setting a general minimum age of 15 years (or 14 for developing countries). It also prohibits hazardous work for anyone under 18. The global fight against child labour was given a new urgency and a concrete deadline when it was integrated into the UN's 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development. Specifically, Target 8.7 of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) calls for immediate and effective measures to eradicate forced labour, end modern slavery and human trafficking, and, by 2025, end child labour in all its forms. To accelerate progress, partnerships like Alliance 8.7 were launched in 2017 to facilitate knowledge sharing and coordinated action. Major global conferences continue to drive the agenda. The 5th Global Conference on the Elimination of Child Labour in Durban, South Africa (2022), adopted the Durban Call to Action, urging renewed commitment. Most recently, the 6th Global Conference in Marrakech, Morocco (2026), adopted the Marrakech Framework for Action, which aims to accelerate implementation and

address persistent challenges by focusing on social justice, decent work for adults, and universal social protection.

6.3 Current situation

To this day in age people countries and people combat child labour and ensuring the protection of minors despite this over a century of international effort, child labour remains a pressing global issue. The COVID-19 pandemic reversed years of progress, pushing millions more children into work. As of recent estimates, approximately 160 million children aged 5 to 17 are engaged in child labour, accounting for nearly 1 in 10 children worldwide. Nearly half of them, about 79 million children, are in hazardous work that directly endangers their health, safety, and moral development.

Child labour is not evenly distributed. Africa has the highest prevalence and absolute number of children in child labour, with nearly one-fifth of all children aged 5-17 affected. The Asia-Pacific region also has a significant number, with 62 million child labourers. The vast majority of child labour, 71%, occurs in the agriculture sector, including farming, fishing, forestry, and livestock herding. This often involves long hours, exposure to pesticides and other hazards, and interferes with school attendance.

The movement recognizes that child labour is both a cause and a consequence of poverty. Families in poverty may rely on a child's income for survival. Lack of access to free, quality education, weak social protection systems, and limited decent work opportunities for adults are major contributing factors.

In conclusion, the history of eliminating child labour is a testament to persistent global advocacy and standard-setting. While monumental strides have been made in creating a powerful legal framework, the persistence of child labour today, exacerbated by crises like COVID-19 and concentrated in sectors like agriculture, shows that the work is far from over. Current efforts now focus on robust implementation, addressing root causes through integrated strategies, and accelerating progress to meet the 2030 target.

6.4 Relevant UN Treaties, Resolutions, and Reports

The previous attempos to solve the problem have been the early National Efforts and the Limits of Legislation. The National Child Labor Committee, established in 1904, became the first effective lobbying group for reforming child labour conditions . These early efforts focused on state by state legislation, but the laws varied widely and were poorly enforced, allowing businesses to simply move to states with close to none regulations. Congress tried in 1919 with a tax on profits from companies using child labour, but this too was declared unconstitutional by the Supreme Court in 1922. After the Supreme Court's rejection of federal child labour laws, reformers set their sights on a more permanent solution: amending the U.S. Constitution. In 1924, Congress passed the Child Labor Amendment and submitted it to the states for ratification . The amendment was straightforward, stating simply: "The Congress shall have power to limit, regulate, and prohibit the labor of persons under eighteen years of age" .

The movement to ratify the amendment gained support from a diverse coalition, including teachers' federations, women's clubs, labor unions, and even African American reformers, who saw its potential to protect Black children in the South . Labor leader Samuel Gompers was a vocal advocate, arguing that child labour was a matter of national concern, much like Prohibition or women's suffrage .

Despite this support, the amendment faced fierce opposition from business groups, particularly in the textile and agricultural industries, who stoked fears of federal government overreach and interference with parental rights . By 1925, the amendment had lost momentum. It ultimately fell short of ratification, garnering support in only 28 of the necessary 36 states .

A global movement was being born, led by the International Labour Organization (ILO), founded in 1919. From its very first conference, the ILO made child labour a central focus, adopting the Minimum Age Convention, in 1919, which set a minimum age of 14 for industrial work . This was followed by conventions for maritime work in 1920 and agriculture in 1921. It ultimately ccame down to two fundamental conventions that form the current global standards. First the ILO Convention 138 (1973): This was a comprehensive attempt to create a universal standard. It requires ratifying states to pursue a national policy to abolish child labour and progressively raise the minimum age for employment to 15 , linking it to the age of mandatory schooling. It also prohibits hazardous work for anyone under 18 . And second the ILO Convention 182 (1999), reflecting a global consensus that certain forms of child labour are so grave they require urgent action, this convention targets the worst forms of child labour. These include slavery, trafficking, forced recruitment for armed conflict, prostitution, and pornography as well as any work that is likely to harm the health, safety, or morals of children. It became the fastest ratified convention in ILO history .

6.4 Guiding questions (These questions are here to help with your position and research.)

- How can your country ensure safety?
- What do you think your country should focus on in terms of ensuring the safety of minors and child protection?
- How do different countries interpret and apply protections for minors and child labour particularly in conflict situations involving state and non-state actors?
- How should the UN and its member states address and enforce accountability for child labor?
- How can the UNHRC strengthen cooperation with ILO, UNICEF, and other agencies?
- How can humanitarian agencies and international organizations improve practical support programs, preventions of child lanout, to better protect children ?
- How does child labour increase during armed conflict and humanitarian crises?
- How can international cooperation be strengthened to ensure safety for minors?

6.5 Blocks positions

Countries	*Block Positions*
Afghanistan	*Afghanistan possesses a strong legal framework (Minimum age: 14, prohibition of hazardous work) as an ILO member, but enforcement has collapsed under the de facto Taliban authorities. The primary issue has shifted from enforcement to a humanitarian crisis of education access and rising poverty*
Austria	Austria recently reinforced its international commitment by ratifying ILO Convention 138 in 2023. Domestically, it features a complex, state-based regulatory system with ongoing debates about reform and data collection to better protect working children
Burundi	Barundi has a minimum age of 16 and is working to extend labour protections to the informal sector. Its main challenges are high child labour ratesand ensuring sc hool attendance is compulsory up to the minimum employment age
China	China prohibits employment of anyone under 16, enforced through a multi-departmental government system. The focus is on strict administrative enforcement, education to prevent dropouts, and links to compulsory schooling laws
Democratic Republic of the Congo	The DR has a minimum age of 14 and is strengthening labour inspection in the informal economy. Key concerns include high rates of hazardous child labour) and the need to align laws on "light work" and dangerous work for adolescents with

	international standards
France	France maintains a highly developed legal framework aligned with ILO standards. The general minimum working age is 16, . Certain hazardous work is prohibited before age 18. Recent parliamentary attention focuses on protecting vocational students—who are often minors—from workplace accidents and preventing abuses like night work for minors .
Germany	Children in germany from ages 13-14 may perform only light work with parental consent, maximum 2 hours a day . Young people 15-17 may work up to 8 hours/day, 5 days/week, with restrictions on night and weekend work . Special exceptions exist for cultural/artistic performances (theatre, film, TV) for children as young as 3, requiring official permits, medical certificates, and school approval .
Iran	Iran's 1990 Labour Code strictly prohibits employment of persons under 15 years old . Workers aged 15-18 are classified as "young workers" and receive special legal protections. For occupations hazardous to physical or mental health, the minimum age is 18 . The Ministry of Cooperatives, Labour, and Social Welfare designates which jobs are considered hazardous. Mandatory medical examinations apply when initially hiring young workers
Italy	Italy's legal framework protects all minors regardless of nationality, with compulsory education applying to all children present in Italy. The Penal Code criminalizes labour exploitation through Article 603-bis ("caporalato" or gangmaster system). However, academic analysis reveals the Italian legal system is inadequately equipped to address new forms of online child exploitation emerging from the digital economy, including content production on

	social media and employment in the competitive video game industry
Niger	Niger publicly recommits to ILO conventions and SDG Target 8.7 to end child labour. The government aims to progressively raise the minimum employment age and better regulate youth activity. At the 6th Global Conference in Marrakech, Niger joined global calls for accelerated action, acknowledging that progress toward eliminating child labour is stalling .
North Korea	North Korea operates entirely outside international labour norms and rejects UN scrutiny. Information is highly restricted, but UN reports document state-directed forced labour as a feature of state policy, with children used in forced labour "shock brigades" for hazardous work in mining and construction. Children from lower social classes are most vulnerable.
Pakistan	Pakistan's labour laws are decentralized, with provinces enacting their own legislation. Generally, children under 14 are prohibited from working. In January 2026, the National Child Rights Commission drafted comprehensive legislation specifically targeting child domestic labour, proposing to criminalize it as a non-bailable offense and establish a uniform child rights framework nationwide aligned with the UN Convention (defining a child as under 18)
Qatar	Qatar positions itself as a global leader against child labour, with a comprehensive legal framework prohibiting child employment without exception . The country has ratified ILO conventions, prohibits minors under 18 in key sectors, combats human trafficking, and established multilingual grievance mechanisms . Qatar emphasizes prevention through education,

	investing heavily in global education initiatives in 2024, implementing over 50 educational projects across 77 countries, enabling 14.7 million previously out-of-school children to access education
Russia	Russia maintains a minimum working age of 16 under the Labour Code, with protections for young workers . The government has recently adopted measures to combat illegal employment, including a 2024 resolution establishing interdepartmental commissions and a public register of employers found using illegal labor (effective January 2025) .
Sudan	Sudan's legal framework includes a minimum age of 14 under the Child Act of 2010, with exceptions for agricultural work and grazing. Children under 12 may not be employed, while those aged 12-15 are permitted to perform work under the Labour Code of 1997
Turkey	Turkey has established Units for Combating Child Labour in all 81 provinces and implemented the National Programme on the Elimination of Child Labour (2017-2023). The government has extended Conditional Cash Transfer for Education to refugee children, benefiting nearly 811,000 children. Turkey is an Alliance 8.7 Pathfinder Country committed to SDG Target 8.7
Uganda	Uganda raised its minimum employment age to 16 under the Children (Amendment) Act of 2016, though the initial ILO ratification specified age 14. The National Action Plan on child labour (NAP II) 2020/21-2024/25 prioritizes prevention, protection, and rehabilitation. Uganda participates in the ACCEL Africa project addressing child labour in tea and coffee supply chains
USA	he UK maintains a compulsory school age of 16, with local authorities empowered to make by-laws authorizing light work for children aged 13 in specified categories

	(newspaper delivery, shop work, agriculture, office work, etc.). Under the Management of Health and Safety at Work Regulations 1999, employers must conduct risk assessments and prohibit hazardous work for those under 18
Uk	The Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA) sets a minimum age of 16 for agricultural employment in occupations declared "particularly hazardous," though children of any age can work on family farms. In 2010, the Department of Labor revised Hazardous Orders to prohibit under-18s from additional dangerous occupations (poultry slaughtering, forestry, operating wood chippers) .

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